Fascism - Towards a Post-Gramscian Framework

Paul Bowman

November 7, 2026

Fascism - Towards a Post-Gramscian Framework

This paper will try to answer the three questions implied by the title, namely "Why a (heterodox Marxist) framework?", "Why Gramsci?" and "Why POST-Gramscian?". To this end we will cover a brief history of the inadequacies of the Comintern's wildly varying attempts to define fascism (Kominternkritik). Followed by a cursory overview of the different dissident approaches from Zetkin, Thalheimer, Trotsky and Gramsci and why the latter has potentials the former three lack. Controversially, we will propose that we need to break with Gramsci on the foundational question of civil society being part of the ideological superstructure, to return to a more Marxologically correct relation between state and society in which civil society is part of the socially productive base, not the "unproductive" superstructure. This refactoring in no way dimishes the key strategic role of civil society in class and power struggles. Dylan Reilly's concept of fascism as based on civil society organisation is further reinforced by this clarification of the base/superstructure relation. As are Gramscian concepts central to understanding fascism, such as passive revolution, relations of force (contra "balance of power" schemas like Bonapartism), organic crises, opposition to the twin perils of mechanicism and ideologism, and so on. Finally we review by looking at the January 2026 Battle of Minneapolis as an illustration of civil society anti-fascist counterpower defeating the of a MAGA police forces assault fatally undermined by lack of supportive reactionary grassroots mobilization.

Proposer: Paul Bowman, eidgenossen@gmail.com. Independent scholar.

Introduction

On reflection I realise that my abstract for this paper opens with three open questions. I still intend to provide the answers to those questions in this presentation, but I think to focus matters a little I want to pose two yes/no questions to frame the debate a little and "call the question", so to speak.

The two yes/no questions are:

"Is fascism a form of passive revolution or a kind of 'reactionary Jacobinism'?"

"How do we distinguish between United Front and Popular Front strategies in an era where the mass working class organisations of a century ago no longer exist?"

The first one is more a question of theory and the second more one of strategy. But obviously those are never entirely separate - questions of theory always turn out to have strategic implications, and questions of strategy can never be definitively settled without the aid of some theoretical tools.

To get down to it, first we need to review the "orthodox story" - the theories of fascism put forward at different times by the Communist Internation (Comintern).

The Comintern and its Discontents

The Comintern and fascism, 1922–1941: a trajectory of degeneration

What follows is my own interpretation, written from a libertarian communist position, and readers from other traditions will disagree with much of it. My challenge applies to all of them all the same. Every leftist anti-fascist has to draw up their own balance sheet of this history. That balance sheet should rest on the full record, not on the truncated, self-serving version passed down by whichever participants their own tendency favours. Even loyal defenders of "Comrade Stalin" have to say which of the mutually incompatible positions the Comintern adopted over its 24 years they consider relevant today. Kominternkritik is a necessary foundation for any serious left anti-fascist politics.

My central argument is that the Comintern's analysis of fascism, from the Fourth Congress of 1922 to the Nazi-Soviet Pact of 1939–41, was not an evolution. It was a process of cumulative theoretical and ideological degeneration. Theory usually moves from crude first approximations towards greater accuracy. This one moved in the opposite direction. Recognising that inversion is essential for two reasons. It explains why successive dissidents rebelled when they did. It also shows that the 1935 "Dimitrov Line" was the end product of a process of decay, not the culmination of a theoretical progression.

The Fourth Congress (November 1922). Mussolini came to power days before the Congress opened, and fascism's sudden appearance caused severe consternation among the delegates. Zinoviev, then in the ascendant, kept the topic off a tightly controlled agenda. He raised it for the first time in his closing speech, which was not open to discussion. This control-freakery backfired. His formulations were vague and contradictory, and the intended line was so illegible that the period that followed saw the most open debate on fascism in the Comintern's history.

The Third Enlarged ECCI Plenum (June 1923). Clara Zetkin's speech to this plenum was arguably the high point of Comintern thinking on fascism. Roger Griffin notes that the resolution it influenced acknowledged four things later Stalinist orthodoxy would reject:

- Fascism had a genuine revolutionary dimension.
- Its revolutionary rhetoric appealed to some workers.

- It had an autonomous anti-capitalist and anti-liberal dynamic, while remaining liable to become a tool of the bourgeoisie.
- As a manifestation of capitalism, it had an intrinsically international character.

Trotsky, Thalheimer and Gramsci were all in Moscow at the time. Even if we cannot be sure they were present for the speech, they were almost certainly part of the discussions it provoked.

The same indeterminacy that allowed this openness also produced a crude counter-tendency. Horthy's Hungary, the 1923 coups in Spain and Bulgaria, and other repressive regimes were all labelled "fascist," with little analytical distinction from Mussolini's Italy.

The Fifth Congress (1924). The failure of the 1923 "German October" ended hopes that the revolution would spread to Germany. The International accepted in practice, though not in rhetoric, that the post-1917 revolutionary tide had ebbed. The United Front, with its limited cooperation with social democrats where local conditions allowed, became the working framework. The rhetoric moved the other way. Zinoviev described social democracy and fascism as "twins," and Stalin called social democracy "objectively the moderate wing of fascism."

The Sixth Congress (1928). This Congress met after a series of disasters:

- Britain: backing the Anglo-Russian Committee trade unionists who torpedoed the 1926 General Strike.
- Poland: initial support for Piłsudski's coup.
- China: forcing the CCP into the KMT under the "Bloc of Four Classes," which led to the April 1927 Shanghai Massacre.

At home, Stalin had exiled Trotsky, deposed Zinoviev and dispensed with Bukharin. He was abandoning the NEP for forced industrialisation, which had originally been a Trotskyist policy. Reversals on this scale needed ideological cover, and "periodism" provided it. The imperialist epoch was divided into sub-periods:

- a first period of revolutionary upsurge;
- a second period of relative stabilisation, for which the United Front had been correct;
- a third period of terminal crisis and rising revolution.

The Third Period called for open hostility to every non-revolutionary force, and above all to the "social fascists." The 1929 crash then turned the Congress's prediction into proof of the supernaturally prophetic powers of "scientific Marxism."

The Thirteenth ECCI Plenum (December 1933) and the Seventh Congress (1935). By 1935, any illusion that Hitler would be a brief interlude before a German communist victory had

collapsed, and periodism went with it. The Seventh Congress swung to the Popular Front. This was a much broader alliance than the United Front, open to any fraction of a "progressive bourgeoisie" defined, more or less opportunistically, by its opposition to fascism.

The formula that defines fascism as "the open terrorist dictatorship of the most reactionary, most chauvinistic, and most imperialist elements of finance capital" is usually credited to this turn. In fact it comes from the Thirteenth Plenum's theses, adopted on Otto Kuusinen's report. That report was a product of Third Period ultra-sectarianism through and through, as its headings on "social fascism" show.

The formula itself is weaker than its reputation, for two reasons:

"Finance capital." The term meant Hilferding's Finanzkapital, popularised by Lenin: a near-merger of national industrial and banking capital. It did not mean Wall Street finance. Kuusinen had in mind the Ruhr heavy-industry bloc (Krupp, Thyssen, Vereinigte Stahlwerke, IG Farben) allied with Schacht's Reichsbank. This was the same bloc that had backed the DNVP–NSDAP Harzburg Front against the Young Plan.

"Most imperialist." The rival, export-oriented bloc that supported the Young Plan was the one most invested in capital export, which Lenin treated as imperialism's defining feature. Calling the Ruhr bloc "most imperialist" therefore confuses the analytical sense of imperialism with the moral sense of being most warlike.

It is open to question whether the formula has any real theoretical content. It passed unchanged from Third Period sectarianism to Popular Front opportunism, two diametrically opposed strategies. The claim that it can guide anti-fascist strategy today therefore appears indefensible.

Let's summarise the stages of decline in Table 1.

Table 1: Stages of Comintern Doctrine, 1922–1935

Congress/Plenum	Period	Ideological keywords
4th Congress (Nov 1922)	First Period: confusion & openness	Zinoviev's closing speech; illegible line; open debate
3rd ECCI Plenum (Jun 1923)	Theoretical high point	Zetkin; revolutionary dimension; worker appeal; autonomous dynamic; international; loose use of "fascist"
5th Congress (1924)	Second Period: stabilisation	Post-German October; United Front in practice; "twins" thesis; "moderate wing of fascism"
6th Congress (1928)	Third Period: ultra-left turn	Periodism; terminal crisis; "social fascism"; anti-NEP; 1929 crash as vindication
13th ECCI Plenum (Dec 1933)	Late Third Period	Kuusinen report; finance-capital formula; Hilferding/Lenin; Ruhr heavy-industry bloc
7th Congress (1935)	Popular Front	Dimitrov Line; "progressive bourgeoisie"; cross-class alliance; formula carried over unchanged

Let's try and tease out the elements of dogmatic blockage - at a fairly high level of abstrac-

tion admittedly - for forming a matrix for comparison of where the dissidents departed from it

The underlying issues with Comintern 'orthodoxy'

The theoretical blockages of the Comintern's eventual orthodoxy fall under four headings: epochalism, mechanicism, binarism and historicism.

Epochalism is the assumption that every country goes through the same epoch of capitalism at the same time, with the same balance of class forces everywhere. On this view there are no local conditions and no combined and uneven development. It was a tendency rather than a dogma. Still, the Comintern saw itself as a world party making policy for every country, and that pushed it institutionally towards one-size-fits-all analysis.

Mechanicism is Gramsci's term from his critique of Bukharin. It gives structure one-sided priority over agency, the forces of production priority over the relations of production, and the base priority over the superstructure. Ideology becomes an epiphenomenal reflection of the base. Agency goes untheorised, so strategy swings opportunistically between fatalism and voluntarism.

Binarism treats class struggle as a game with two players. Besides flattening real class structures, it reduces power to a relative see-saw between the two sides. It cannot conceive of bourgeoisie and proletariat both being weak in absolute terms at the same time.

The Comintern's own revolution rested on a worker–peasant alliance, so its binarism lay less in how many classes it counted than in how many outcomes it allowed. Historicist teleology permitted only two futures: a failing capitalism or socialist revolution. Only two classes could therefore have independent historical agency.

This meant strategies like the ill-fated merging of the Chinese Communist Party into the KMT under the slogan of the "Bloc of Four Classes" was safe. Safe because in a region where imperialist colonialism was the "main contradiction" the proletariat would be guaranteed leadership of any nominally anti-imperialist coalition. It's worth noting that the Popular Front was in many ways a return to the Bloc of Four Classes policy, just with Fascism/Anti-fascism as the new "main contradiction" and the "progressive bourgeoisie" taking the place of the "national bourgeoisie".

In The Only Road (1932), Trotsky calls the petty bourgeoisie decisive yet "incapable of an independent policy," while conceding that it is the majority in several countries. He treats that incapacity as given rather than explaining it. The same presuppositions led the KPD to read Hitler as the next failing chancellor after Brüning, Papen and Schleicher, and that Trotsky shared them is significant.

Historicism is the teleology that allows only one kind of revolutionary rupture at each level of development: bourgeois before the Paris Commune, socialist after it. A rupture that produced a regime neither bourgeois nor proletarian was unthinkable. So the Italian regime after 1925 and the German regime after 1933 were classed as bourgeois at the base, with a

fascist "ideological deviation" in the superstructure. At the limit, this became the ultra-left denial of any real difference between fascism and bourgeois democracy. That "superstructural ideologism" is still the dominant approach today.

Table 2: Horizon-limits of the Comintern.

Title	Horizon
Epochalism	universal conjuncture
Mechanicism	all structure, no agency
Binarism	balance of power
Historicism	only socialist revolution is possible

The Dissidents – Zetkin, Thalheimer, Trotsky, Gramsci

Clara Zetkin

The Comintern never formally sanctioned Zetkin. Instead she was silenced bureaucratically: informally from 1924, after she opposed Zinoviev at the Fifth Congress, and almost completely after 1928, when the party press stopped mentioning or printing her. Partly for that reason, and partly because of her health, she never developed her analysis beyond the 1923 speech. That speech still gives present-day anti-fascist research a starting point outside Comintern dogma. On the rubric she leaves question marks rather than answers: she stands for an alternative line that was possible, not one that was worked out.

August Thalheimer

The KPD's leading theoretician, Thalheimer fell foul of both Stalin and Trotsky and has been largely ignored by both traditions. His "On Fascism", prepared for the Sixth Congress in 1928, was never adopted, and he was expelled soon after. Yet his ideas on Bonapartism and on fascism as a form of "the open dictatorship of capital" were taken up by Kuusinen and others, minus that qualifier, and became the basis of the Dimitrov line. He breaks most clearly with epochalism by insisting that national conditions and levels of development differ. He is clear of crude Bukharinist mechanicism but stays within binarism and historicism.

Leon Trotsky

Trotsky was expelled a year before Thalheimer. He started writing on fascism inside the ECCI (the 1926 "Polish mistake" commission), but most of that work dates from his exile. He blamed Thalheimer for the 1923 German defeat, so the two never engaged, even though Trotsky borrowed Thalheimer's Bonapartism thesis without acknowledgement. Both men worked in a

tradition that put factional warfare ahead of theory. Trotsky breaks with mechanicism's fatalist pole and seems to break with binarism. But mechanicism comes back in his voluntarism and vanguardist protagonism. And binarism persists in his view that non-proletarian, non-bourgeois class fractions have no ideology or interests of their own.

Antonio Gramsci

As our chosen guide out of the traps and impasses of Comintern orthodoxy, we are going to talk about Gramsci in more detail below. But in summary, like Thalheimer he insists on the relevance of different levels of development in Italy (as he did while originally backing Bordiga in 1924 in opposing the United Front policy). The critique of mechanicism we are using is substantially his. His move from balance of power to multi-level relation of forces is the key move beyond binarism. But his failure to break with historicism is why he never explored with the idea of fascism being actively revolutionary.

Let's move to a summary of the position of the dissidents in terms of the rubric I outlined earlier.

Table 3: Comintern Dissidents Scorecard

	Epochalism	Mechanicism	Binarism	Historicism
Trotsky	✗	✓	✗	✗
Thalheimer	✓	✓	✗	✗
Gramsci	✓	✓	✓	✗

Why Gramsci?

Hopefully the matrix above we just went through gives some idea of why I think that of all four, Gramsci is the richest seam to mine. Despite the some of the limitations we will come to in a minute, I think particularly on the question of power, Gramsci's move from a balance of power perspective to the three level relations of force model is possibly the most useful development. It opens up a wider discussion on power that I think is absolutely necessary in distinguishing fascism from other far right tendencies, like far right populism in its various forms. To that end, I would like to share another quick figure mapping out the different aspects of power. The first aspect is really cardinality - i.e. how many powers are we talking about? Two? Three? Many? Or only one (Hegel's model of the state as the sole protagonist of history).

You'll notice that it is really only the quality end of the above table that is explicitly covered by Gramsci. I feel that in his work as a whole he's exploring aspects of social power that very much approach qualitative questions without necessarily explicitly articulating them in that form. But counterpower, for example, is not in his vocabulary. Which begs the question of just how "post" is this supposedly "post-Gramscian" model going to be?

Dichotomies

	Relative	Absolute	Vector	Dimension	Composition
A	More	Strong	Down	Vertical	Power
B	Less	Weak	Up	Horizontal	Counterpower
	Quantity		Quality		

Dialectics

Hegemony Transversality

Figure 1: Aspects of power: dichotomies and dialectics.

But first a quick pic on the dynamics of power - which owes much to Dylan Riley's account in Civic Foundations of Fascism in Europe.

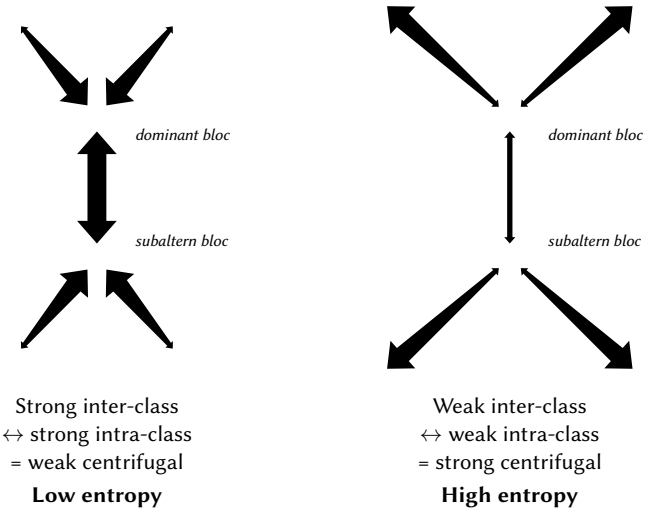


Figure 2: Dynamics of intra-class and inter-class power

Recognising a debt without claiming to be a faithful reading of Gramsci

I have gained a great deal from reading Gramsci and also the works of scholars working in the Gramsci studies field. But this paper cannot be a contribution to that field, because its beyond my learning, time and capacity. And also it is not my purpose which is sketching out a possible working model of fascism useful primarily to anti-fascists. So by "post-Gramscian" I mean to signal recognising the debt owed both to Gramsci and the various writers who have suggested ways of reading him. But I don't intend to be limited by any misplaced ambition to be "properly Gramscian", whatever "properly" means in this context. I also take some distance from some of Gramsci's starting assumptions about the relationship between base, superstructure and ideology. I don't want to derail too much, but here is a brief list of nine "non-identities"

that signal where I am not following what I understand (rightly or wrongly) to be Gramsci's position (or positions, given the evolution of his thought over time) on these three key topics.

$$
\begin{aligned}
\text{superstructure} &\neq \text{plurality} \\
\text{ideological classes} &\neq \text{intelligentsia} \\
\text{ideological superstructure} &\neq \text{genitive case} \\
\text{civil society} &\neq \text{superstructure} \\
\\
\text{superstructure} &\neq \text{ideology}^{*} \\
\text{ideology}^{*} &\neq \text{ideas} \\
\\
\text{religion} &\neq \text{superstructure} \\
\text{political society} + \text{civil society} &\neq \text{state} \\
\text{ideology} &\neq \text{trench} + \text{fortress}
\end{aligned}
$$

Figure 3: Nine Non-Identities of the Superstructure

But to some extent the base/superstructure/ideology discussion, important as it is, is a side-issue here. What's more important is cataloguing which of Gramsci's concepts and distinctions I want to appropriate for use here.

Table 4: Term selection

civil society	*vs*	state
relations of forces		
mechanicism	*vs*	ideologism
organic crisis	*vs*	conjunctural crisis
economic-corporatism	*vs*	(counter-)hegemonic bloc

In relation to that last item, hegemony is one of Gramsci's most famous concepts, especially outside of Marxist contexts. In the non-Marxist discourse this tends to be because it is easily misread as being synonymous with Weberian ideas of legitimacy. But within Marxist circles a number of writers since the 70s have felt it necessary to create the term counter-hegemony to distinguish the contrasting meanings within this one word. Similarly Bob Jessop found it useful to distinguish between historic bloc and hegemonic bloc. Using the former for the totality of the political-ideological composition of a given social formation in a given time - here I think the regulation school's concept of mode of regulation fits quite well. And the aspect of intra-class and inter-class relations of political forces. Here I think we need to detect an ambiguity in what the word "consent" is doing within that pair of "hegemony protected by the armour of coercion". The reluctant or fatalistic consent of the subaltern to the status quo, under the open threat of coercion and backed up by the "mute compulsion" of labour market

forces and TINA ("There is no alternative") is an entirely different form of consent from the volutary coalition of forces who cannot be compelled or coerced by their peers. Peer consent and subaltern "consent" are not the same thing.

By extension domination-hegemony and coalition-hegemony are two different beasts. In relation to the first, we can say that proletarian autonomy is an antonym to bourgeois hegemony. But proletarian autonomy needs political composition - within which we can see the role of moral leadership of the "first among equals", or coalition-hegemony. Hegemony cannot be its own opposite. It cannot be both the cause and effect of domination while at the same time being cause and effect of resistance to domination.

There's a note to be made here about Gramsci's addiction military metaphors from the First World War, which was an example of symmetrical warfare. In general the distinction between symmetrical and asymmetrical struggles does not arise in Gramsci. The nearest he gets is the struggle between hegemonies pushing in "direzioni contrasti" - contrasting directions. It sounds like our vector element of power, but there's no sense of an up or down or any qualitative difference in the directions other than that they are pushing against each other like the battlefront trench lines of WW1.

Civil Society as the Terrain for Building Counterpower - Fascist and Anti-fascist

The theoretical statement of the model relies on the assumptions that fascism is still a useful category of analysis for present day social phenomena. And that fascism is a far-right tendency but not all far-right political tendencies are fascist.

A further assumption is that while there has been a continual presence of fascist groupuscules since the 1920s to present day, the threat of fascism is related to particular historical conjunctures. Specifically the condition of organic crisis at the societal or international level. The possibility of a crisis at an international level relies on the ideas of "modes of regulation" like Keynsianism or neoliberalism that can be copied and shared internationally between different countries, particularly in the richer OECD sphere, voluntarily rather than imposed by force. In our current situation I propose that we are in the organic crisis of an exhausted neoliberalism in conjunction with a declining or threatened US global geopolitical domination. That since the crash of 2008 we are in a classic Gramscian interregnum where a great number of morbid symptoms appear, including the possibility of fascism stepping off the pages of the history books and back onto the streets.

What distinguishes fascism from other forms of far right politics like the counter-revolutionary military dictatorships of Pinochet, the Greek Colonels, the Brazilian and Argentine Juntas, etc, is its "reactionary Jacobinism". That fascism builds a civil society based counter-hegemonic bloc based on reactionary far-right ideology. And uses that counterpower in two directions - horizontally to repress any rival progressive civil society counterpower - and vertically to put

pressure on a decaying, dis-united and fragmenting dominant class bloc in order to accelerate its crisis of political composition and to find an ally among the most far-right sympathetic dominant class fraction. To attain power fascism is not making itself the tool of a united bourgeosie, it is going into partnership by a fraction of that bourgeoisie that is unable to gain inter-class hegemony over the rest of its class and is desperate enough to enter a cross-class alliance with a violent "plebian" counterpower capable of intimidating its rivals and wider society into submission.

Fascism = far-right ideology + counterpower politics

Amongst other things, this means we recognise that Neumann's polycentric model of the Nazi regime in Behemoth is more correct than Pollock's version of state capitalism. While recognising that Neumann's traditional bias to capital- and state-centric views of the social prevented him from understanding the polycentric nature of the Nazi dictatorship as a monstrous hybrid of constituted and the reactionary constituent power harnessed by the party.

So to answer my opening question of theory - "Is fascism a form of passive revolution or a kind of 'reactionary Jacobinism'?". My answer is the latter. What distinguishes fascism specifically from other forms of far-right political movements is its use of the strategy of active revolution rather than passive revolution. And that the building of a civil society counter-hegemonic counterpower as a lever to gain power is the differentia specifica of fascism as a form. That is the element that remains constant while the actual ideological content of its far-right imaginary can vary widely.

Case Study - Stemming the Flow of Operation Metro Surge

What was Metro Surge? Operation Metro Surge began in December 2025. DHS deployed roughly 3,000 personnel, more than the metro area's 10 largest local police departments combined. The civil resistance to it peaked in January, after ICE agents killed Renee Good (7 January) and Alex Pretti (24 January). Border czar Tom Homan announced on 12 February that the operation would soon end.

What kind of scale are we talking about? With all the usual caveats on sources, self-reporting by organisers, etc, we can still estimate that around 30,000–35,000 people were formally trained as observers statewide between November and February. Active participation in some form ran into the tens of thousands, and the 23 January mobilisation drew 50,000–100,000 depending on the source.

The fallout was the sacking of key people like Kristi Noem, Greg Bovino, etc. For once the bad guys lost. It was a stunning victory for the people of the Twin Cities and Minnesota (albeit not one without cost) and one that seriously wounded the MAGA regime's spectacle of being an unstoppable transgressive force. It is no coincidence that the ill-fated war against Iran began within weeks of Hogan's admission of defeat.

In our neo-Gramscian framework the resistance campign built a civil society counterpower

on the principals of direct action, solidarity, mutual aid under the slogan of defending their neighbours. Their confrontation with the federal state forces of the CBP and ICE can be mapped very clearly onto the paradigm of asymmetrical warfare. Whether it can in some way be framed as an instance of war of maneuvre or war of position is beyond me. I'm not saying it can't be done. But am querying how useful that exercise would be.

So were the heroic citizens of Minnesota fighting fascism? Yes and no. They were certainly fighting a policy of far-right terror by the Trump 2.0 administration. A policy of setting the dogs of the Customs and Border Patrol and ICE on the population of the Twin Cities Metro area. One also inspired by the desire for revenge for the 2020 George Floyd uprising that began there from the likes of Stephen Miller and other ideologically fascist power players in the White House. But if the CBP and ICE were the Gestapo, there were no Brownshirts to back them up. So, yes, the resistance was fighting fascist policy, but it wasn't confronted with fascist street power - just the repressive arm of the state. Had MAGA been able to mobilise a civil force of even 10 to 20 thousand red cap street thugs to go out and physically attack the resistance away from the cops and the cameras, the outcome might well have been different. But MAGA is an electoral constituency (mostly not of fighting age or fitness) not a direct action capable fighting force.

No counterpower no cigar.

So the last item is to return to the second question I opened with, the strategic one of "How do we distinguish between United Front and Popular Front strategies in an era where the mass working class organisations of a century ago no longer exist?"

Earlier I advanced the contention that the Popular Front strategy was in many ways a re-branding or recycling of the Bloc of Four Classes strategy that Trotsky so corrected criticised as a perversion of the idea of a United Front of proletarians, peasants and other toiling classes. In a US context that would mean making an alliance with the centrist Democrats against Trump and MAGA. Specifically that would mean suborning our anti-fascist activism to the veto of the centre-left wing of the very political establishment that have brought us to the current organic crisis of neoliberal breakdown. But if there are no mass organisations committed to working class identity and autonomy the United Front cannot really be built on the level of coordination between existing party political organisations. Which does not mean we should exclude registered Democrats from our organisations. Rather that the basis of United Front activity needs to be based on values like solidarity, mutual aid and civil activism through direct action in the here an now, rather than actionless waiting on the next round of the electoral system.

This year's turn of the electoral wheel has recently rid us of Orbán, Vučić and severely dented Trump's power in the last days. But ICE is still out there casually killing people (most recently by running over a fleeing man in their 4x4) for the crime of looking hispanic. Sitting on our hands for the next two years or watching the Congressional enquiry dog and pony show is not an option. And if Trump was too lazy and incompetent to build an effective

fascist counterpower, that does not mean that the next incarnation of MAGA - or whatever replaces it - will not do so. If the thesis that we are stuck in the interregnum of neoliberalism's crisis and the failure to find a replacement regime of accumulation is correct, then fascism will not disappear with Trump's final retirement to the golf course or even a putative Democratic presidential win in 2028.

Support the Minnesota 15!

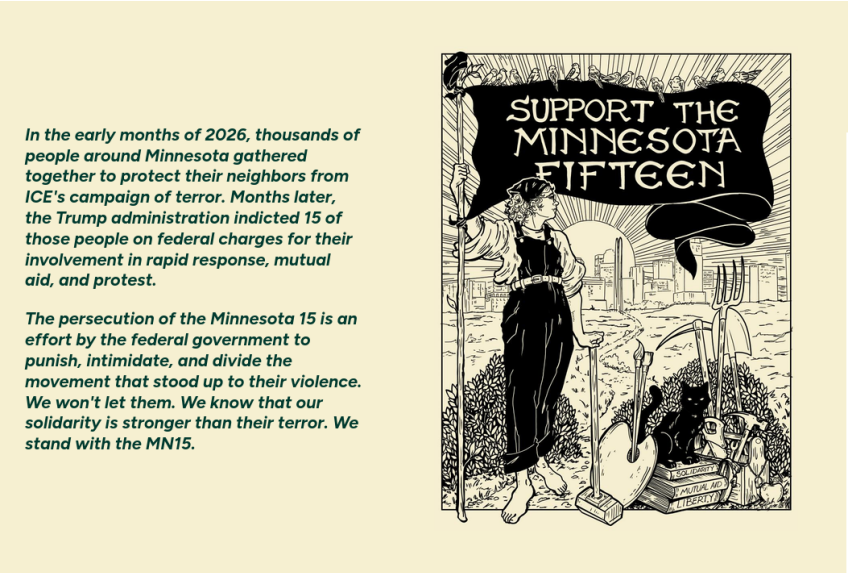


Figure 4: Defend the Minnesota 15!

`https://minnesota15.org/`
`https://github.com/eidgenossen/HMPapers`
"Moreover… ICE must be destroyed"